

Grown-up's Playbook: The Honey-Cake Feast

The answers are here. This part is for the grown-up, not for the child.

The Honey-Cake Feast: Rules for the Grown-Up

New to this? Read the Guide for the Grown-Up first. It explains the whole idea in two pages and you will never need it again.

You are the Game Master, which here means a few small jobs at once: storyteller, gentle referee, the children's biggest fan, and a fellow adventurer who plays along. This is a cooperative game for two or more who play together, a grown-up and one or more children, all on the same side. Nobody competes, and nobody loses. This is a warm, gentle tale about sharing and making room for everyone, and no one in it is ever truly hurt or left out.

Setting up

- Print the map. Each player puts a small figure on the Start, the Olive Town.
- This world has no magic. Instead each hero leans on one of three qualities: **Wits** (clever thinking), **Courage** (a steady heart), or **Heart** (caring for others). On the hero sheet, where it says magic, let each child write the quality they like best. Two different qualities work best together.
- Give each player five energy stars (five small tokens or bricks). They are spent and refilled during play.
- Set out a prop or two if you can: an empty jar or cup for the honey, a few buttons or beads for flowers, and a round biscuit or a paper circle for the honey cake. Anything can be anything.
- Keep your dice and the dice-band table from the back of the kit beside you.

Difficulty bands, not dice

Challenges never call for a particular die. Each one has a band: **Easy**, **Normal**, or **Hard**. When the players try something, look up the band on the kit's dice-band table, which tells you the number to meet or beat with whatever dice your family owns. Every challenge can be played with a single ordinary die.

The golden rule: here nobody loses

A failed roll is never a defeat. It is a detour to a different route. When a roll does not meet the band, the players always have a way through:

- **Spend an energy star** to gather themselves and try the idea again, or
- **Join two qualities** once per stop to pass with no roll at all (Wits and Heart together, say, or Courage and Wits).

Energy stars come back when the players move on to the next stop, and when they help each other. Nobody can ever run dry for long, and nobody is ever stuck.

Helping each other: the Helping Hand

At any moment one player may help another instead of acting alone. When they do, make the help roll: on a success the challenge is passed for the pair, even if the first roll missed. Helping is generous, so reward it; it also tops up an energy star. In these hills, no hero stands alone.

The Twist of Fate

At each stop, once, the players may roll for a twist and you read out the matching line. Use whichever die the dice-band table gives you for this; with a single ordinary die, read the line that matches the number rolled.

Roll	Twist of Fate
1	A friendly satyr gives you one free hint.
2	You find your courage again, and take back one energy star.
3	A favourable wind, and the next challenge is Easy.
4	Chiron the centaur passes by and nods kindly. All is well.
5	An olive branch for luck: keep one roll to use again later.
6	A burst of birdsong, and for a moment everyone feels brave.

How it ends

There is no foe in this tale. The Cyclops was once the lonely giant of the spring, but he is a friend now, and the only challenge left is a happy one: to make him feel truly welcome. The adventure is won by asking the bees kindly, sharing the cake so that everyone has enough, and giving a shy friend the courage to come to the table. Let the sharing and the welcome land; that is the whole point. See the puzzles page for the three challenges and their solutions.

The Honey-Cake Feast: Puzzles and Solutions

For your eyes, not the children's. Each stop lists its band, what the players need to work out, the intended solution, and a gentle fallback so a stuck child always moves forward. More than one good idea should work; reward cleverness and kindness over the "right" answer.

Stop 1: The Hill of Bees (Easy)

The challenge. The Hill Bees keep the sweetest honey, but they will only share with someone who comes gently. The players need to fill the empty jar.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Observation moment. The kind move is to slow down and stay calm, not to swat or snatch: approach softly, offer the bees a few meadow flowers, and ask politely. Happy bees fill the jar themselves.

Fallback. If the children rush and the bees scatter, have **Bramble the Satyr** show them how to hum a low, friendly note, or let a player spend an energy star to calm everyone down. Asking kindly always works, and tops up an energy star.

Stop 2: Milo's Kitchen (Normal)

The challenge. Milo's honey cake must be shared so that every guest at the feast gets a piece and nobody is left out, including the very large Cyclops.

Intended solution. This is a Maths and Heart moment. Count the guests together (a handful of townsfolk, Daphne, Milo, the two heroes, and the giant). Cut a slice for each, and remember that fair does not mean identical: the giant is ten times the size, so he needs a much bigger slice, while the smallest child is happy with a small one. Any plan where everyone has enough is a success.

Fallback. If the counting feels hard, have Daphne count the guests aloud on her fingers, or let the children line up one biscuit or pebble per guest and match them to the slices. Getting there with help still counts as a full success and tops up an energy star.

Stop 3: Fetching the Friend (Normal)

The challenge. The Cyclops is shy to come down to a whole townful of people. He fears he is too big, or that the townsfolk will be afraid of him. The players must give him the courage to come.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Courage moment. Any honest, warm reassurance works: telling him plainly that he is wanted, reminding him that the town are his friends now, showing him the grand slice saved just for him, or offering to walk down at his side. Kindness, not cleverness, carries this stop.

Fallback. If the children are unsure what to say, have the giant ask quietly, "Are you really sure there is room for me?" A single kind word is enough, and down the hill he comes.

The ending

There is no battle and no loser. When the honey is gathered, the cake is shared, and the giant takes his seat, the whole **Olive Town** feasts together under the olive trees with nobody left out, and wise **Athena** smiles down from the mountain. The heroes have won the only way anyone wins here, by being clever, brave, and kind.

Wits and Wonder

Grown-up's Playbook

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.